Spatial Cognition or Pattern Matching?

Re-examining CityGPT (Feng et al.) — KDD 2025

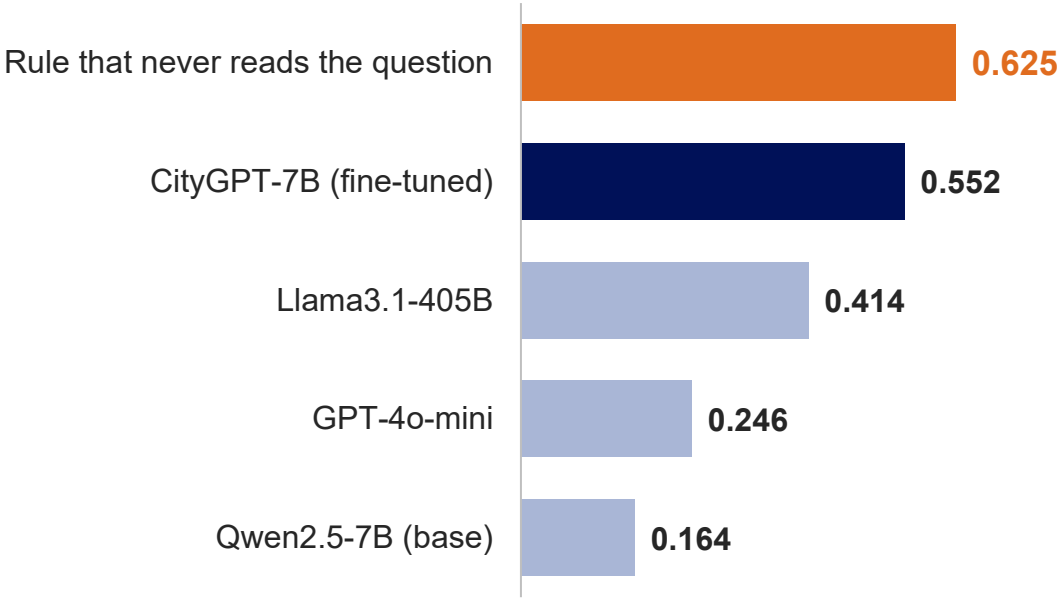
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Spatial reasoning accuracy on CityEval, Beijing



Scores: Feng et al., CityGPT (KDD '25), Table 1. Rule: expected score on the released CityEval v2.3 (picks distance answers by rank, guesses direction).

What I add

1. **Retrain**
   my own CityGPT-style model (no checkpoints are released)
2. **Break the shortcut**
   fair options, no options, fictional places, unseen cities
3. **Fix the data**
   retrain without the pattern and measure the gain that survives

Did it learn the city, or the test?

Thank you for your attention



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